

module-02-panchabhuta - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - primary band

Module 2 — Panchabhūta — The Five Elements (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Pañcabhūta* · **Band:** Primary (3-5) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

The classical Indian classification of matter.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 2's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Hold a glass of water. “*What can water do?*” (Flow, splash, freeze, evaporate.) Now an ice cube. “*Still water?*” (Yes — different form.) “*In India long ago, people said matter has FIVE basic forms — like five friends. Today we meet them.*”

Core idea · 15 min

Meet the five friends: - **Pr̥thvī (पृथ्वी)** — Earth. *Solid stuff.* Rocks, mountains, bones. - **Ap (अप)** — Water. *Liquid stuff.* Rivers, blood, juice. - **Tejas (तेजस)** — Fire. *Warm stuff.* Sun, candles, body warmth. - **Vāyu (वायु)** — Air. *Moving stuff.* Wind, breath, the smell of food. - **Ākāśa (आकाश)** — Space. *Where everything fits.* The room, the sky, the gap between hands.

Make a hand sign for each friend. Practice 3 times.

Demonstration · 10 min

Element walk. Stand in a line. The teacher names one element; children mime it: - Pr̥thvī → stand strong like a mountain - Ap → wave arms like water - Tejas → flicker like a flame - Vāyu → blow softly - Ākāśa → spread arms wide and breathe deep

Repeat 3 times, faster each time. Cheer at the end.

Source moment · 5 min

Tell the story of *Pañcabhūta* as five family members of Earth. “*They each have a job. Pṛthvī gives us food. Ap gives us drinks. Tejas warms us. Vāyu brings us smells and breath. Ākāśa makes room for everyone.*”

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Five-friends drawing. Each child folds a paper into 5 sections. In each section, draw something for that element (sun for tejas, balloon for vāyu, river for ap, mountain for pṛthvī, sky for ākāśa). Decorate. Share.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

Each child names their favourite element and why. Group hug at the end (representing ākāśa connecting everyone).

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Five friends — meeting the elements
- **Day 02** — Earth and water — solid and liquid
- **Day 03** — Five qualities, five senses (tanmātras)
- **Day 04** — Fire and air — energy and motion
- **Day 05** — Ākāśa — the fifth element
- **Day 06** — Modern parallels — states of matter
- **Day 07** — Pañcabhūta in Āyurveda — bridge to Module 4
- **Day 08** — Pañcabhūta in cuisine — six tastes
- **Day 09** — Pañcabhūta in nature — local examples
- **Day 10** — Synthesis project: build a pañcabhūta poster

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.